CHIDO ZINYAKATIRA

Data Scientist | Data Analyst | Business Analyst
Target roles: Data Scientist, Data Analyst, Business Analyst (Junior to Mid-level)
Harare, Zimbabwe | Remote | linkedin.com/in/chido-zinyakatira-327246255 | github.com/chidozinyakatira |
chidozinyakatira.github.io/chidozinyakatira

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data Scientist with econometric foundation (Wits BSc Economic Science) and ML specialisation (Eduvos Honours, Distinction 75%). Ranked **top 17% globally (131/766)** in Zindi ML competitions. Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate (Mar 2026). Delivers production-ready Python/R/SQL solutions with statistical rigour Econometrics III, Mathematical Statistics II. Nine months professional experience in FAIS-regulated financial services. Available immediately.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Tools: Python (pandas, scikit-learn, XGBoost, NLTK, NumPy), R (tidyverse, ggplot2, caret), SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL, BigQuery), Excel (VLOOKUP, INDEX/MATCH, pivot tables, regression, VBA)
Machine Learning: Classification, regression, clustering, NLP/LDA, ensemble methods (XGBoost, Random Forest), hyperparameter tuning (Optuna), time series, feature engineering, pseudo-labelling
Statistical Modelling: Linear & logistic regression, hypothesis testing, causal inference, econometrics implemented in Python, R, and Excel
Big Data & Cloud: Google BigQuery, Microsoft Azure, Apache Hadoop, Hive, Pig, MADlib
Visualisation & BI: Tableau, Power BI, matplotlib, ggplot2, Excel dashboards, Git/GitHub, Jupyter

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data & Analytics Analyst | Finhealth Risk Solutions Apr 2025 – Dec 2025
Johannesburg, South Africa | FAIS-regulated financial services

- Built SQL/Python ETL pipelines consolidating multi-source financial data automated anomaly detection reduced policy lapses by 15% through proactive risk flagging
- Designed FSCA-aligned compliance monitoring dashboards in Tableau and Excel, replacing manual spreadsheet workflows and cutting reporting time significantly
- Performed regression and time series analysis on 60+ client portfolios translated findings into structured management reports and client-facing recommendations
- Automated recurring reporting processes with Python scripts; maintained full audit trail documentation aligned with regulatory standards
- Built a commission reconciliation dashboard in Excel breaking down agent performance, payment accuracy, and key financial metrics delivered monthly as part of regulatory reporting to management

Business Operations Intern | Safeway Risk Solutions Jan 2024 – Feb 2024
Johannesburg, South Africa | Financial services

- Maintained 99% data accuracy across 200+ client records through systematic validation and QA processes

EDUCATION

BSc Honours, Data Science | Eduvos May 2026 (ceremony) | Completed Dec 2025
Distinction (75%) | Research Project: 92% | Big Data Analytics: 82% | Machine Learning: 72%
Research Project: GDP Forecasting & Economic Volatility — github.com/chidozinyakatira/gdp-forecasting-economic-volatility

BSc Economic Science | University of the Witwatersrand 2022 – 2024
Economics & Computational Applied Mathematics | Econometrics III, Mathematical Statistics II, Macroeconomics III

KEY PROJECTS & COMPETITIONS

- **Zindi Financial Health Prediction | Ranked 131/766 globally |** Built ensemble ML pipeline (XGBoost, Optuna, pseudo-labelling) predicting financial behaviour from demographic and transaction data
- **Zindi DigiCow Farmer Adoption | Ranked 103/388 |** Predicted technology adoption behaviour from structured demographic and engagement data
- **News Intelligence NLP Platform |** Automated content categorisation system processing large-scale article data using scraping, cleaning, and LDA topic modelling — reduced manual classification effort
- **Customer Churn & Segmentation |** SQL extraction, logistic regression churn model, K-Means clustering, Tableau dashboard with segment-level intervention recommendations

CERTIFICATIONS

Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate – Google (Mar 2026) | SQL Intermediate – HackerRank | Python Basic – HackerRank | R Basic – HackerRank | Ethical AI in Practice – data.org